

# Milana Kostić

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## Areas of Specialization

Epistemology, Philosophy of Language, Decision Theory, Feminist Philosophy

## Areas of Competence

Philosophical Logic, Philosophy of Science and Technology

## Education

PhD studies in Philosophy, University of Southern California, in progress

Dissertation *Conditionals in Inquiry and Deliberation*

Committee: Andrew Bacon (chair), Dmitri Gallow, John Hawthorne, Jeff Russell, Deniz Rudin

PhD studies in Philosophy, University of California, San Diego, 2019-2022.

M.A. Logic and Philosophy of Science, Munich Center for Mathematical Philosophy, Ludwig Maximilians Universität, 2018.

B.A. Philosophy, University of Belgrade, 2015.

Study Abroad: University of Warsaw, 2013-2014.

## Publications

### *Edited Book*

*Structural Injustice in Philosophy* (Bloomsbury Academic); co-editor with Maeve McKeown and Seunghyun Song, *forthcoming*.

### *Journal Article*

On the Utility of Research into Geoengineering Technologies for Risk-avoidant Agents *Philosophy of Science*, volume 90(5), 2023.

### *In Progress*

Conditionalizing on Conditionals, *R&R*

Learning Conditional Probabilities, *draft available*

Sexual Care Ethics, *draft available*

## Awards, Grants, and Fellowships

Flewelling Fellowship, USC Philosophy Department

USC Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant

Institute for Practical Ethics (IPE) Fellowship, UC San Diego, 2021-2022.

UCHRI Multicampus Graduate Student Working Group Award, project co-PI with Jingyi Wu, Faculty PI: Cailin O'Connor

Scholarship 'Dositeja' for Students Studying Abroad, Serbian Ministry of Youth and Sports, 2015-2017, 2019-2021.

DAAD scholarship for master studies at the Munich Center for Mathematical Philosophy, 2015-2017.

The Best Student Graduated from the Faculty of Philosophy, University of Belgrade in 2015-2016 Academic Year

Scholarship 'Dositeja' for Young Talents, Serbian Ministry of Youth and Sports

Erasmus Mundus Scholarship (for an exchange year at the University of Warsaw)

## Conferences and Workshops

### *Presentations*

Evaluating Risk-Weighted Expected Utility of Research into Geoengineering Technologies, PSA 2022 Meeting

Evaluating Risk-Weighted Expected Utility of Research into Geoengineering Technologies, Institute for Practical Ethics PhD Fellows Meeting, UC San Diego

Belief Dynamics for Stalnaker Bernoulli Models, SemBabble Research Group, UC San Diego

Belief Dynamics for Stalnaker Bernoulli Models, Formal Philosophy 2021, Laboratory for Logic, Linguistics and Formal Philosophy, Higher School of Economics Moscow

Updating with Restrictor Conditionals, Fourth Philosophy of Language and Mind Master Class with Angelika Kratzer, University of Salzburg

Updating with Restrictor Conditionals, Fifth Graduate Conference on the Philosophy of Probability, London School of Economics

Towards a Probabilistic Account of Epistemic Modality, Situations, Information and Semantic Content, Munich Center for Mathematical Philosophy, poster presentation

### *Comments*

*On the Non-Compositional Dynamics of If*, Mathias Boehm, Central APA 2024

## Organization

MAP Session: “Anti-racist Pedagogy as Harm Reduction”, Central APA 2022, co-organizer

MAP Session: “Public Philosophy and Activism”, Central APA 2021, co-organizer

MAP Session: “Countering Bullying, Harassment, and Micro-aggressions”, Eastern APA 2021 (online), co-organizer

Workshop: “Improving Classroom Dynamics”, Munich Center for Mathematical Philosophy, co-organizer and moderator

Panel Discussion: “What Is It Like to Be a Woman in Mathematical Philosophy?”, MCMP Summer School for Women in Philosophy, co-organizer and participant

## Participation

North American Summer School in Logic, Language and Information, Brandeis University (online)

Master Class with Sally Haslanger, Ludwig Maximilians Universität

Summer School in Mathematical Philosophy for Female Students, Munich Center for Mathematical Philosophy

## Research Positions

Graduate Research Assistant for the "Logical Consequence" project (PI: Gila Sher, UCSD Philosophy)

PhD Fellow, UCSD Institute for Practical Ethics

## Teaching Positions

### *at USC Philosophy Department*

PHIL168: Meaning of Life (Merrick Anderson), Spring 2026

PHIL176: Introduction to Feminist Philosophy (Emily Tilton), Fall 2025

PHIL220: Introduction to Logic (Gabriel Uzquiano), Spring 2024

PHIL108: Philosophy, Politics, and Economics in Europe, from Renaissance to Enlightenment (1375-1800) (Jacob Soll), Fall 2023

### *at UCSD Sixth College Culture, Art, and Technology Writing Program*

CAT1 The Transformation of Cities (history course), Fall 2020

CAT2 Cities and States (anthropology course), Winter 2021

CAT3 Representation and Rights: Disability in History and the Arts, Spring 2021

CAT125 Public Rhetoric, Fall 2021

CAT2 Media-Made America: America's Small-Screen Geographies (communication studies course), Winter 2022

CAT3 Our Future Climate: Envisioning Our Collective Future, Spring 2022

### *Additional Teaching Experience*

Teaching Assistant at UCSD Summer Program for Advancement of Women in Philosophy

## Pedagogy Training

Advanced Teaching Philosophy Seminar, 14-Week course, Philosophy Department, USC

Future Faculty Teaching Institute, 14-Week course, Center for Excellence in Teaching, USC

Corrupt the Youth Volunteer Training, 2-hour session, Briana Toole

Teaching Philosophy Seminar, 14-Week course, Philosophy Department, USC

Introduction to College Teaching, 10-Week course, Sixth College, UCSD

## Service

### *Diversity and Inclusion*

Corrupt the Youth LA chapter, Volunteer, 2024-5

Minorities and Philosophy (MAP) International, Co-director, 2021-2

Minorities and Philosophy (MAP) International, International Organizer, 2019-2021

Minorities and Philosophy (MAP) chapter at MCMP, founding chapter member and organizer, 2018

### *To the Department*

MAP USC Mentoring Program, 2024-5

Graduate Student Mentor at USC Philosophy Department, 2023-4, 2025-6

UC San Diego Summer Program for Advancement of Women in Philosophy, Advisory Board Member, 2020-2

Traditionally Underrepresented Genders Group (TUGG), Quarterly Meeting Organizer, 2020-1

### *Public Philosophy and Outreach*

Elise Woodard, Carolina Flores, Milana Kostic, Angela Sun, and Jingyi Wu, "Setting Boundaries: Personal and Professional," *Philosophers' Cocoon*, May 2020

### *Refereeing*

USC-UCLA Graduate Conference

European Journal for Philosophy of Science

## Affiliations

American Philosophical Association, 2021-

Philosophy of Science Association, 2022-

## Graduate Coursework

### *Area Exam*

Higher-order Logic, Semantics and Metaphysics (with Andrew Bacon)

Model Theory and Non-standard Analysis (with Gabriel Uzquiano)

Analysis, Topology, Measure Theory (with Jeff Russell)

Feminist Philosophy and Sexual Ethics (with Robin Jeshion)

### *Language and Epistemology*

Introduction to Contemporary Philosophical Literature (Soames, USC)

Epistemic Normativity (Hawthorne, Lasonen-Aarnio, Wedgewood USC)

Probability (Holliday, Mancosu, UCB)

Conditionals and Conditional Attitudes (Yalcin, UCB)

Intellect (Sher, UCSD)

Topics in Recent Epistemology (Carr, UCSD)

Philosophy of Probability and Statistics (Landes, MCMP)

Introduction to Formal Semantics (Stern, MCMP)

Formal Epistemology (Poellinger, Osimani, MCMP)

### *Logic*

Higher-order Logic\* (Bacon, USC)

Modal Logic (Uzquiano, USC)

Intensional Semantics\* (Walsh, UCLA)

Varieties of Philosophical Logic (Gratzl, MCMP)

Formal Theories of Truth (Fischer, MCMP)

Central Topics in Logic: Logic and Probability (Leitgeb, MCMP)

Central Topics in Logic: Metaphilosophy (Leitgeb, MCMP)

Formal Methods I: Logic and Set Theory (Gratzl, MCMP)

*Philosophy of Science and Decision Theory*

Rational Choice (Wedgewood, USC)

History and Philosophy of Science Seminar in Biomedical and Social Sciences, with Special Attention to Race and Psychiatry (Cartwright, UCSD)

Time's Arrow (Chen, UCSD)

Science, Values, and Environment (Callender, UCSD)

Naturalism and Naturalistic Metaphysics (McKenzie, UCSD)

Central Topics in Philosophy of Science: Philosophy of Social Sciences (Herfeld, MCMP)

Central Topics in Philosophy of Science: Bayesian Philosophy of Science (Hartmann, MCMP)

Formal Methods II: Models and Simulations (Wheeler, MCMP)

*Ethics, Social and Political Philosophy*

Value in a Vast and Uncertain World\* (Russell, USC)

Philosophy of Law (Quong, USC)

Feminist Thinking on Sex and Love (Jeshion, USC)

Introduction to Contemporary Literature on Value (Quong, USC)

Trust (Wonderly, UCSD)

*History of Philosophy*

Greek Theories of Pleasure and Pain (Johnson, UCSD)

Kant's Political Philosophy (Metaphysics of Morals) (Allais, UCSD)

*Other*

Advanced Psycholinguistics\* (Kaiser, USC Linguistics)

## Dissertation Abstract

How likely is it that a fair die lands on six if an even number is rolled? Most people immediately answer  $1/3$ , since the probability of landing on six conditional on the even number being rolled is  $1/3$ . This simple intuition reflects a broader idea: the probability of a conditional statement matches the conditional probability of the consequent (landing on six) given the antecedent (landing on an even number). However, until recently there was a near consensus in the literature that this statement, also known as Stalnaker's thesis, is untenable in light of David Lewis's triviality results. Lewis showed that any theory assigning conditional sentences propositions cannot at the same time satisfy Stalnaker's thesis. The dominant reaction to Lewis's triviality results among philosophers has been to embrace a form of expressivism, i.e., to claim that we do not use conditional sentences to make truth-evaluable claims about the world. This seemingly minor theoretical choice has had far-reaching implications across several areas of philosophy, including philosophy of language and semantics, epistemology, and decision theory.

The aim of my dissertation is to respond constructively to Lewis's triviality results. Building on the recent work by Van Fraassen and Bacon, who showed that the intuition behind Stalnaker's thesis can be honored within a truth-conditional framework if we assume that conditionals are context-dependent, I argue that within the contextualist framework not only a version of Stalnaker's thesis can be shown to be formally consistent, but that it provides a philosophically attractive framework in which the problems for epistemology, the semantics of conditionals, and decision theory can be avoided. In Chapter 1, I show that within the contextualist framework, strengthened by the principle I introduce (the Factual Independence Principle) it is possible not only to model learning conditional information in the way we learn declarative statements, i.e., by conditionalizing on the proposition expressed, but also to correctly predict all the relevant test cases discussed in the literature. In Chapter 2, I show that my framework can be used to model learning (conditional) probabilities. Moreover, in my framework it is possible to show that learning conditional probabilities and learning probabilities of conditionals has the same effects in the standard cases. In Chapter 3, I argue that a uniform theory of indicative and counterfactual conditionals can be given within such contextualist framework. I show that such theory can help us explain the effects of learning counterfactuals. In Chapter 4, I discuss ramifications of the uniform thesis-conforming theory of conditionals for decision theory. I present a general formal decision theory that includes causal and evidential theory as special cases, discuss its formal properties and applications.

Last updated: August 10, 2026